

MeitY announces #FOSS4GOV Innovation Challenge

MeitY has announced the #FOSS4GOV Innovation Challenge to accelerate adoption of Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) in government. This challenge calls upon FOSS innovators, technology entrepreneurs and Indian startups to submit



implementable open source product innovations in CRM and ERP with possible applications for GovTech in health, education, agriculture, urban governance, etc.

Participants will be eligible for incubation support, prize money, mentorship by domain experts, institutional support from eminent organisations for incubation of ideas, and listing of solutions on

GeM. Details about the challenge and how to participate will be shared soon by the ministry through MyGov and the MeitY Startup Hub.

India is well positioned to become a vibrant hub for Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) innovations due to the large number of 4G data subscribers in India, 96 per cent of who access the digital world via open source based mobile operating systems (primarily Android). Some of India's largest government projects (including Aadhaar) and many technology startups have also been built using FOSS.

JFrog announces the availability of JFrog DevOps Platform Enterprise+

JFrog Ltd has announced that the JFrog DevOps Platform Enterprise+ plan is available on the Google Cloud Marketplace as a SaaS subscription. The JFrog DevOps Platform, a multi-cloud, universal DevOps platform, drives continuous software releases from source to any deployment target. Google Cloud customers can now quickly and easily deploy the JFrog Platform with full Enterprise+ subscription capabilities in just a few clicks via the Google Cloud Marketplace.

According to a company statement, "The JFrog Platform Enterprise+ subscription is a comprehensive DevOps offering from JFrog designed to enable



large enterprises to support the needs of modern application delivery at scale including binaries management, container registry, built-in security, CI/CD pipelines, and advanced distribution capabilities."

The Enterprise+ subscription includes JFrog Artifactory, a universal package management and container registry solution,

and JFrog Xray enabling DevSecOps at scale with continuous scanning for security vulnerabilities and licence compliance for open source dependencies. It also includes 'JFrog Distribution and Hybrid Edges' that accelerates secure software distribution across large scale hybrid infrastructure footprints, edges, IoT, and remote offices and JFrog pipelines with end-to-end CI/CD automation and orchestration.

API3 and Open Bank Project initiate a ten-year development partnership

API3 has entered into a ten-year development partnership with Open Bank Project to connect over 400 banking and open banking APIs directly to blockchains via API3's Airmode, all housed under open source code.



Open banking is a practice by which banks provide authorised third-party providers with access to banking data through the use of application programming interfaces (APIs). The most well-known open banking initiative is the revised Payment Services Directive (PSD2) – an EU regulation passed in 2015, which requires banks to create mechanisms that enable third-party providers to work securely, reliably and rapidly with the bank's services and data on behalf and with the consent of their customers.

Open Bank Project and API3 will enable banks to send data directly to blockchain networks through the use of API3's Airmode first-party oracle. This provides third-party decentralised application developers with the opportunity to begin rapidly prototyping blockchain solutions powered by open banking data. Potential use cases for open banking data on blockchains are numerous, and include solutions like secure and decentralised databases for data verification between banks and authorised third parties, the bridging of open banking data to blockchain-native systems like DeFi and self-sovereign identities, and data marketplaces and data unions enabling banking customers to monetise their private financial data.

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